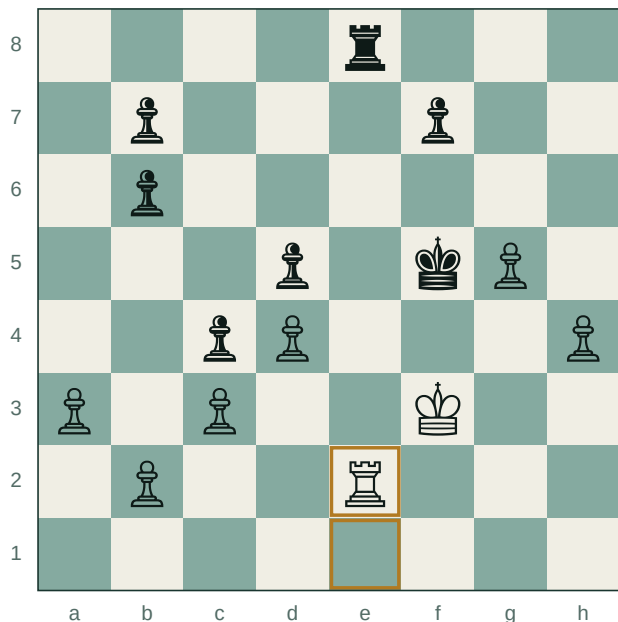


# Rook-ending tactics: Black, move 34

Rook-ending tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 34.Rxe2. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

**WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST**

**34...Rxe2 35. Kxe2 Kg4 36. g6 fxg6**

**34...Rxe2** The rook captures the rook on e2. Recorded reply: **35.Kxe2**.

**35...Kg4** The king moves from f5 to g4. Recorded reply: **36.g6**.

**36...fxg6** The pawn captures the pawn on g6.

At the end, nominal material is White 5 / Black 5 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +1. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

**CHECKPOINT**

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +1:** the balance goes from -1 to +0. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

**CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES**

A routine rook placement can miss a skewer or promotion with check. Let concrete tactics override a guideline when they conflict.

**WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES**

Rook endings combine pawn races with checks, cutoffs, and promotion tactics. Activity is vital, but the exact move order often decides whether a pawn can advance safely.

**HOW TO LOOK**

Check the kings' exposure, the rooks' checking distance, and the passed pawns. Calculate forcing checks before applying a general rook-ending rule.

The defending king is on f3. Look for a defender that can be displaced or overloaded.